

I Bind Unto Myself Today

Words: attributed to St. Patrick of Ireland (circa 387-466). Paraphrased by Cecil F. Alexander, 1889.
Music: 'St. Patricks Breastplate' Charles V. Stanford, 1902. Setting: "The English Hymnal", 1906.
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♩ = 120

The musical score is written for a four-part vocal choir (Soprano, Alto, Tenor, Bass) and piano accompaniment. The key signature is three sharps (F#, C#, G#) and the time signature is 3/4. The tempo is marked as quarter note = 120. The score consists of three systems of music. The first system contains five lines of lyrics, each corresponding to a different part of the choir. The second system contains two lines of lyrics. The third system contains two lines of lyrics. The piano accompaniment is written in the right and left hands, with the right hand often playing chords and the left hand playing a bass line. The lyrics are as follows:

1. I bind un - to my - self to - - day The strong Name of the
2. I bind this day to me for - - ev - er By pow - er of faith, Christ's
3. I bind un - to my - self the pow - er Of the great love of
4. I bind un - to my - self to - - day The vir - - tues of the
5. I bind un - to my - self to - - day The pow - er of God to

Tri - - ni - - ty,
in - - car - - na - - tion;
cher - - u - - bim;
star lit heav - - en,
hold and lead,

By in - - vo - - ca - - - tion
His bap - - tism in the
The sweet "Well done" in
The glor - - ious sun's life
His eye to watch, His

The first system of the musical score is written in D major (two sharps). It consists of a vocal line on a single treble staff and a piano accompaniment on two staves (treble and bass). The vocal line begins with a quarter note D4, followed by a quarter note E4, and then a half note F#4. The piano accompaniment features a steady eighth-note pattern in the right hand and a similar pattern in the left hand, with chords that support the vocal melody.

The second system of the musical score continues the vocal and piano parts. The vocal line has a first ending bracket labeled '1' that leads to a final whole note D4. The piano accompaniment provides harmonic support with chords and moving lines in both hands, ending with a final chord in D major.

The third system of the musical score includes a vocal line with a long melisma, indicated by a bracket labeled '2-9'. The lyrics 'same riv er, ho ur, ray, stay,' are written below the vocal line, with hyphens indicating the continuation of the melody. The piano accompaniment continues with chords and moving lines in both hands, providing a harmonic foundation for the vocal part.

2. His burst - - - ing from the
3. Con - - - fes - - - sors' faith, A - - -
4. The flash - - - ing of of the
5. The wis - - - dom of my

up - pray - ers, the heav'n - ly way, His com - - ing
the the pro - - phets' scrolls, All good deeds
wind's guide, tem - - pest - - uous shocks, The sta - - ble
His shield to ward; The word of

6. Against the demon snares of sin,
The vice that gives temptation force,
The natural lusts that war within,
The hostile men that mar my course;
Or few or many, far or nigh,
In every place and in all hours,
Against their fierce hostility
I bind to me these holy powers.

8. Christ be with me, Christ within me,
Christ behind me, Christ before me,
Christ beside me, Christ to win me,
Christ to comfort and restore me.
Christ beneath me, Christ above me,
Christ in quiet, Christ in danger,
Christ in hearts of all that love me,
Christ in mouth of friend and stranger.

7. Against all Satan's spells and wiles,
Against false words of heresy,
Against the knowledge that defiles,
Against the heart's idolatry,
Against the wizard's evil craft,
Against the death wound and the burning,
The choking wave, the poisoned shaft,
Protect me, Christ, till Thy returning.

9. I bind unto myself the Name,
The strong Name of the Trinity,
By invocation of the same,
The Three in One and One in Three.
By Whom all nature hath creation,
Eternal Father, Spirit, Word:
Praise to the Lord of my salvation,
Salvation is of Christ the Lord.